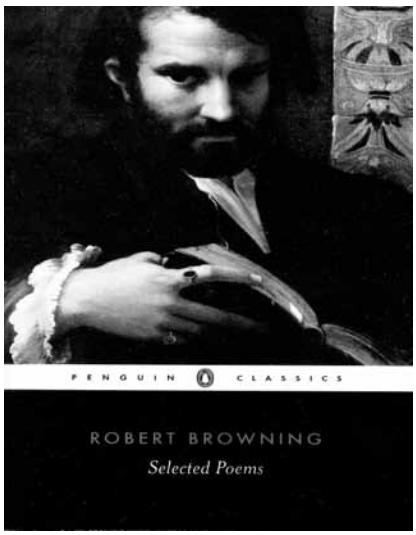
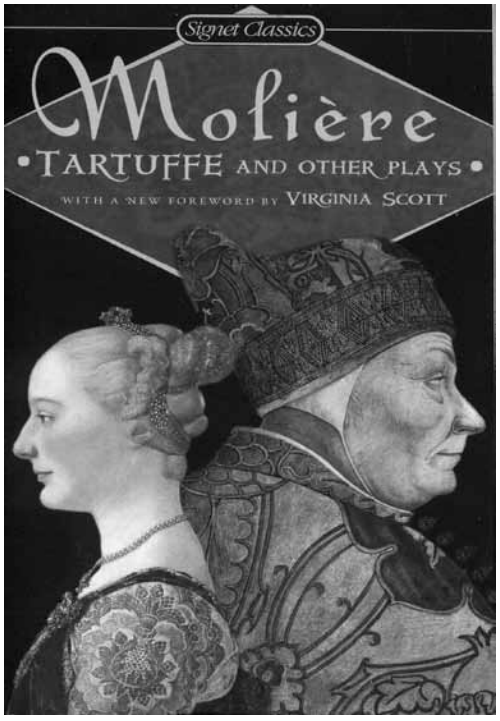
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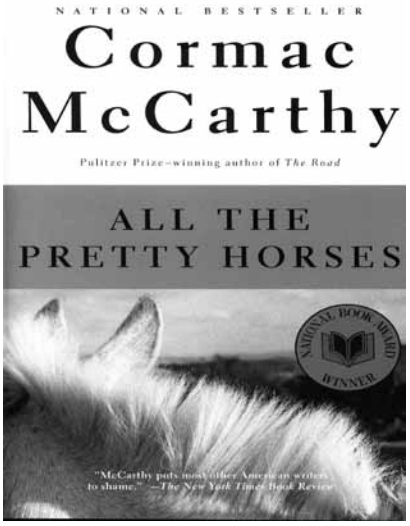
Making a World of Difference

Literary Criticism

Invitational A • 2014







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University Interscholastic League
Literary Criticism Contest • Invitational A • 2014

Part 1: Knowledge of Literary Terms and of Literary History **30 items (1 point each)**

1. The word meaning 'rebirth' commonly applied to the period of transition from the medieval to the modern world in Western Europe is

   A) boustrophedon.
   B) jeremiad.
   C) neoclassicism.
   D) renaissance.
   E) structuralism.

2. The period in English literature (1700-1750) that encompasses the reign of Queen Anne and the flourishing of Alexander Pope is called the

   A) Augustan Age.
   B) Caroline Age.
   C) Edwardian Age.
   D) Elizabethan Age.
   E) Jacobean Age.

3. The class of literary work specializing in bloodshed and violence, in the nineteenth century published as dime novels, many examples of which have to do with crime and high emotion, is known as

   A) blood and thunder.
   B) bob and wheel.
   C) cloak and dagger.
   D) cloak and sword.
   E) storm and stress.

4. The poetic foot consisting of an accented and an unaccented syllable, as in the word *happy*, is the

   A) anapest.
   B) dactyl.
   C) pyrrhic.
   D) spondee.
   E) trochee.

5. The first major, self-conscious literary movement of African American writers that resulted in part from a massive migration of young talented writers and poets to northern American cities is known as the

   A) Black Mountain School.
   B) Fugitives.
   C) Harlem Renaissance.
   D) New York Poets.
   E) Parnassians.

6. A word formed by combining the initial letters or syllables of a series of words to form a name is a(n)

   A) acronym.
   B) acrostic.
   C) eponym.
   D) portmanteau word.
   E) telestich.

7. The term applied to the "first" actor, the leader of the chorus, in early Greek drama and that now refers to the central character is

   A) antagonist.
   B) anti-hero.
   C) deuteragonist.
   D) protagonist.
   E) tritagonist.

8. The recipient of the 1990 Pulitzer Prize for Fiction, author of *The Mambo Kings Play Songs of Love* and *Our House in the Last World*, who died in October 2013 is

   A) Jeffrey Eugenides.
   B) Oscar Hijuelos.
   C) Jhumpa Lahiri.
   D) John Phillips Marquand.
   E) Michael Shaara.

9. **Not** among North American women known for their twentieth-century poetry is

   A) Maya Angelou.
   B) Margaret Atwood.
   C) Elizabeth Bishop.
   D) H. D.
   E) Emily Dickinson.

10. The nineteenth-century British author of *Far from the Madding Crowd*, *Jude the Obscure*, *The Return of the Native*, and *Tess of the D'Urbervilles* is

    A) Charles Dickens.
    B) George Eliot.
    C) Thomas Hardy.
    D) Rudyard Kipling.
    E) Anthony Trollope.

11. An analogy identifying one object with another and ascribing to the first object one or more of the qualities of the second is a

A) conceit.
B) metaphor.
C) metonymy.
D) simile.
E) synecdoche.

12. Literature in which literary elements—plot, character, and so forth—are subordinate to the direct expression of moral discernment and truth is called

A) comparative literature.
B) epistolary literature.
C) frontier literature.
D) popular literature.
E) wisdom literature.

13. **Not** designated by Edmund Burke as one of the four master tropes (master because of their role in the discovery and description of "the truth") is

A) irony.
B) metaphor.
C) metonymy.
D) simile.
E) synecdoche.

14. A term of some derision that focuses criticism on the perceived "mutual admiration" of Swinburne, Morris, and, especially, Dante Gabriel Rossetti is

A) the Cockney School.
B) the Fleshly School.
C) the Martian School.
D) the Satanic School.
E) the Spasmodic School.

15. A group writing in and about New York during the first half of the nineteenth century, a group whose association was one of geography and chance rather than of close organization, is the

A) Fugitives.
B) Knickerbocker Group.
C) Lost Generation.
D) Muckrakers.
E) New York School.

16. The Russian author of the novel *Doctor Zhivago* who was forced to decline the 1958 Nobel Prize for Literature is

A) Joseph Brodsky.
B) Ivan A. Bunin.
C) Czesław Miłosz.
D) Boris Pasternak.
E) Mikhail A. Sholokhov.

17. Commonly, a narrative having the characteristics of Icelandic medieval heroic adventures is known as a(n)

A) epic.
B) fabliau.
C) legend.
D) romance.
E) saga.

18. The term coined by E. M. Forster for a character sufficiently complex to be able to surprise the reader without losing credibility is

A) dynamic character.
B) flat character.
C) round character.
D) static character.
E) stock character.

19. Posthumously awarded, among other recognitions, the 1996 Pulitzer Prize for Drama for his rock musical *Rent* is

A) Jonathan Larson.
B) David Mamet.
C) Jason Miller.
D) Howard Sackler.
E) Neil Simon.

20. The nineteenth-century author of *The Marble Faun*, *The House of the Seven Gables*, *The Scarlet Letter*, *The Blithedale Romance*, and *Twice-Told Tales* is

A) Charles Brockden Brown.
B) Ralph Waldo Emerson.
C) Nathaniel Hawthorne.
D) Herman Melville.
E) Henry David Thoreau.

21. The group of writers that includes F. Scott Fitzgerald, Erich Maria Remarque, and Ernest Hemingway, who were born around 1900, some serving in WWI, and who also reacted against certain tendencies of older writers in the 1920s, is known as the

A) Agrarians.
B) Fugitives.
C) Hartford Wits.
D) Lost Generation.
E) Pre-Raphaelites.

22. The continuation of the sense and grammatical construction from the first stanza to the second stanza is called (a)

A) boustrophedon.
B) enjambment.
C) fused rhyme.
D) run-on line.
E) tag-line.

23. The late-nineteenth-century British author whose plays include *An Ideal Husband*, *A Woman of No Importance*, *The Importance of Being Earnest*, *Lady Windemere's Fan*, and *Salomé* is

A) W. S. Gilbert.
B) Thomas William Robertson.
C) George Bernard Shaw.
D) George Sims.
E) Oscar Wilde.

24. The device by which a work presents material that occurred prior to the opening scene of a work is

A) digression.
B) elaboration.
C) flashback.
D) foreshadowing.
E) prolepsis.

25. A speech delivered while the speaker is alone and calculated to inform the audience of what is passing in the character's mind is known as a(n)

A) apostrophe.
B) aside.
C) dramatic monologue.
D) harangue.
E) soliloquy.

26. Drama that presents a view of the ridiculousness and ludicrousness of the human condition through its abandonment of the usual or rational devices and by its use of nonrealistic form is known as

A) *reductio ad absurdum*.
B) Theater of Cruelty.
C) Theater of the Absurd.
D) tragedy of blood.
E) tragicomedy.

27. The United States Poet Laureate 2004-2006 and recipient of the 2005 Pulitzer Prize for Poetry for his collection *Delight and Shadows* is

A) Robert Hass.
B) Ted Kooser.
C) Paul Muldoon.
D) Mark Strand.
E) James Tate.

28. The period of American literature in which Anne Bradstreet, Benjamin Franklin, and Jonathan Edwards flourished as authors is called the

A) Colonial Period.
B) Postmodern Period.
C) Realistic Period.
D) Revolutionary and Early National Period.
E) Romantic Period.

29. A self-contradictory combination of words or smaller verbal units is called a(n)

A) hyperbole.
B) litotes.
C) mimesis.
D) oxymoron.
E) paradox.

30. **Not** a type of rhyme denoting the relationship between or among accented words or syllables constituting exclusively end rhyme is

A) compound rhyme.
B) eye rhyme.
C) identical rhyme.
D) leonine rhyme.
E) masculine rhyme.

Part 2: The UIL Reading List **20 items (2 points each)**

Items 31-36 are associated with Molière's *Tartuffe, or The Impostor.*
Items 37-43 are associated with Cormac McCarthy's *All the Pretty Horses.*
Items 44-50 are associated with Robert Browning's poetry (selected).

31. In Molière's play *Tartuffe*, "Our secret will be safe with us alone, / And there's no evil if the thing's not known" constitutes an authorization from
    A) Tartuffe to Dorine.
    B) Tartuffe to Elmire.
    C) Tartuffe to Flipote.
    D) Tartuffe to Mariane.
    E) Tartuffe to Valère.

32. The tone of Dorine's response, "Your soul will know eternal bliss, / Wedded to such a handsome man as this!" to Mariane's envisioning Tartuffe is
    A) apathetic.
    B) contemplative.
    C) optimistic.
    D) sarcastic.
    E) whimsical.

33. "These are fairy tales that please your ear. / No one else has a chance to talk in here, / While Madame Chatterbox goes on all day [. . .]" refers to
    A) Damis's stories about Orgon's gullibility.
    B) Dorine's mocking assessment of virtue.
    C) Elmire's view of her mother-in-law's advice.
    D) Flipote's recollections of Mme. Pernelle's childhood.
    E) Mariane's explanation to Valère.

34. Accusing Cléante of having had his soul "spattered with freethinking grime" is
    A) Damis.
    B) Elmire.
    C) Orgon.
    D) Tartuffe.
    E) Valère.

35. Molière's comedy *Tartuffe* is set in
    A) Lyon.
    B) Marseille.
    C) Paris.
    D) Stone.
    E) Versailles.

36. The "pleasant-seeming man [. . .] / Sent by Tartuffe on an affair / Which [. . .] will please" Orgon is
    A) Monsieur Deception.
    B) Monsieur Dupe.
    C) Monsieur Gullible.
    D) Monsieur Hypocrite.
    E) Monsieur Loyal.

37. In Cormac McCarthy's *All the Pretty Horses*, John Grady's answer to Rawlins's question "Why aint we dead?" points, ***ultimately***, to
    A) Abuela
    B) Alejandra.
    C) Armondo.
    D) Don Hector.
    E) Perez.

38. The observation "There was no longer even a finger on which to place the ring" serves to offer something of a reason behind the marital status of
    A) Abuela.
    B) Alejandra.
    C) Alfonsa.
    D) Lacey.
    E) Mary Catherine.

39. Among the people whom John Grady meets, the person terribly fearful of lightning is
    A) Jimmy Blevins.
    B) Wayne Cole.
    C) Emilio Perez.
    D) Lacey Rawlins.
    E) Alejandra Rocha.

40. Alejandra is roughly
    A) one year older than John Grady.
    B) one year younger than John Grady.
    C) the same age as John Grady.
    D) two years older than John Grady.
    E) two years younger than John Grady.

41. That "God had put horses on earth to work cattle and other than cattle there was no wealth proper to a man" is an opinion shared by John Grady and

A) Jimmy Blevins.
B) El Charro.
C) Emilio Perez.
D) Lacey Rawlins.
E) Don Hector Rocha.

42. "I know you hadn't crossed [the river because] there's two deer feedin along the edge of them mesquite yon side" is a comeback made by

A) Jimmy Blevins.
B) John Grady Cole.
C) El Capitan.
D) El Charro.
E) Lacey Rawlins.

43. Among those who travel in the one-and-half-ton Ford flatbed truck to Saltillo, the one person who does not get off the truck in Saltillo is

A) Jimmy Blevins.
B) John Grady Cole.
C) the driver.
D) El Capitan.
E) Lacey Rawlins.

Items 44-50 refer to Robert Browning's

Porphyria's Lover

The rain set early in to-night,
The sullen wind was soon awake,
It tore the elm-tops down for spite,
And did its worst to vex the lake:
I listened with heart fit to break.
When glided in Porphyria; straight
She shut the cold out and the storm,
And kneeled and made the cheerless grate
Blaze up, and all the cottage warm;
Which done, she rose, and from her form
Withdrew the dripping cloak and shawl,
And laid her soiled gloves by, untied
Her hat and let the damp hair fall,
And, last, she sat down by my side
And called me. When no voice replied,
She put my arm about her waist,
And made her smooth white shoulder bare,
And all her yellow hair displaced,
And, stooping, made my cheek lie there,
And spread, o'er all, her yellow hair,
Murmuring how she loved me—she
Too weak, for all her heart's endeavour,
To set its struggling passion free
From pride, and vainer ties dissever,
And give herself to me for ever.
But passion sometimes would prevail,
Nor could tonight's gay feast restrain
A sudden thought of one so pale
For love of her, and all in vain:
So, she was come through wind and rain.
Be sure I looked up at her eyes
Happy and proud; at last I knew
Porphyria worshipped me; surprise
Made my heart swell, and still it grew
While I debated what to do.
That moment she was mine, mine, fair,
Perfectly pure and good: I found
A thing to do, and all her hair
In one long yellow string I wound
Three times her little throat around,
And strangled her. No pain felt she;
I am quite sure she felt no pain.
As a shut bud that holds a bee,
I warily oped her lids: again
Laughed the blue eyes without a stain.
And I untightened next the tress
About her neck; her cheek once more
Blushed bright beneath my burning kiss:
I propped her head up as before,
Only, this time my shoulder bore
Her head, which droops upon it still:
The smiling rosy little head,
So glad it has its utmost will,
That all it scorned at once is fled,
And I, its love, am gained instead!
Porphyria's love: she guessed not how
Her darling one wish would be heard.
And thus we sit together now,
And all night long we have not stirred,
And yet God has not said a word!

44. In line 4 of Browning's "Porphyria's Lover," *vex* means

A) bother.
B) calm.
C) drain.
D) engulf.
E) flatten.

45. As with all first-person presentations, the dramatic monologue being no exception, the audience should question the persona's

A) background.
B) diction.
C) intention.
D) purpose.
E) reliability.

46. Scansion of Browning's "Porphyria's Lover" reveals an overall metric pattern of

A) iambic pentameter.
B) iambic tetrameter.
C) iambic trimeter.
D) trochaic pentameter.
E) trochaic trimeter.

47. The very auditory *murmuring* in line 21 is a strong example of

A) ambiguity.
B) hyperbole.
C) litotes.
D) onomatopoeia.
E) synæsthesia.

48. The specific type of end rhyme exhibited in lines 22 and 24 of Browning's poem is

A) beginning rhyme.
B) compound rhyme.
C) feminine rhyme.
D) leonine rhyme.
E) masculine rhyme.

49. The persona's self-assurance, as voiced in lines 41-45, depends on a(n)

A) allusion.
B) hyperbaton.
C) metaphor.
D) simile.
E) volta.

50. The melopoeic quality upon which the force of line 48 depends is

A) alliteration.
B) assonance.
C) consonance.
D) dissonance.
E) euphony.

Part 3: Ability in Literary Criticism
15 items (2 points each)

Items 51-55 refer to Thomas Hardy's

The Voice

Woman much missed, how you call to me, call to me,
Saying that now you are not as you were
When you had changed from the one who was all to me,
But as at first, when our day was fair.

Can it be you that I hear? Let me view you, then,
Standing as when I drew near to the town
Where you would wait for me: yes, as I knew you then,
Even to the original air-blue gown!

Or is it only the breeze, in its listlessness
Travelling across the wet mead to me here,
You being ever dissolved to wan wistlessness,
Heard no more again far or near?

Thus I; faltering forward,
Leaves around me falling,
Wind oozing thin through the thorn from norward,
And the woman calling.

51. The speaker's addressing someone from whom he does not expect an answer in Hardy's "The Voice" is

A) apostrophe.
B) aside.
C) personification.
D) reification.
E) soliloquy.

52. The type of end rhyme exhibited in lines 9 and 11 of Hardy's poem is called

A) assonant rhyme.
B) compound rhyme.
C) heteronymous rhyme.
D) leonine rhyme.
E) triple rhyme.

53. The marked use of the sibilant ("hissing sounds") in, for instance, lines 9-11 is an occurrence of

A) alliteration.
B) assonance.
C) cacophony.
D) sigmatism.
E) syzygy.

54. The overall tone of Hardy's "The Voice" is

A) cheerful.
B) condemnatory.
C) despairing.
D) histrionic.
E) plaintive.

55. The last two lines of the third stanza, lines 11-12, point to

A) absence because of divorce.
B) absence through death.
C) disappearance into quicksand.
D) kidnapping.
E) zombie abduction.

Items 56-60 refer to Robert Frost's

Putting in the Seed

You come to fetch me from my work to-night
When supper's on the table, and we'll see
If I can leave off burying the white
Soft petals fallen from the apple tree
(Soft petals, yes, but not so barren quite,
Mingled with these, smooth bean and wrinkled pea);
And go along with you ere you lose sight
Of what you came for and become like me,
Slave to a Springtime passion for the earth.
How Love burns through the Putting in the Seed
On through the watching for that early birth
When, just as the soil tarnishes with weed,
The sturdy seedling with arched body comes
Shouldering its way and shedding the earth crumbs.

56. The paradoxical strength of line 9 of Frost's "Putting in the Seed" relies on a(n)

A) anachronism.
B) cliché.
C) metaphor.
D) simile.
E) tautology.

57. The placing of a sentence element out of its normal position to accommodate the rhythm and rhyme of line 5 is an instance of

A) analogue.
B) barbarism.
C) inversion.
D) malapropism.
E) solecism.

58. The poem's final couplet features

A) auditory imagery.
B) gustatory imagery.
C) olfactory imagery.
D) tactile imagery.
E) visual imagery.

59. The tone suggested by the descriptive phrasing "the soil tarnishes with weed" is

A) appreciative.
B) insulting.
C) lighthearted.
D) pessimistic.
E) uninterested.

60. The form of Frost's poem is a variation of the

A) Italian sonnet.
B) Miltonic sonnet.
C) Petrarchan sonnet.
D) Shakespearean sonnet.
E) Spenserian sonnet.

Items 61-65 refer to John Crowe Ransom's

Blue Girls

Twirling your blue skirts, travelling the sward
Under the towers of your seminary,
Go listen to your teachers old and contrary
Without believing a word.

Tie the white fillets then about your hair
And think no more of what will come to pass
Than bluebirds that go walking on the grass
And chattering on the air.

Practice your beauty, blue girls, before it fail;
And I will cry with my loud lips and publish
Beauty which all our powers shall never establish,
It is so frail.

For I could tell you a story which is true;
I know a lady with a terrible tongue,
Blear eyes fallen from blue,
All her perfections tarnished—yet it is not long
Since she was lovelier than any of you.

61. In "Blue Girls" line 10's "loud lips" constitutes (a)

A) conceit.
B) metonymy.
C) paradox.
D) pun.
E) zeugma.

62. Lines 3-4 of Ransom's "Blue Girls" suggest the poem's admonitory

A) ambiguity.
B) connotation.
C) theme.
D) trope.
E) typology.

63. The comparison central to the second stanza of Ransom's poem is a(n)

A) analogy.
B) antithesis.
C) metaphor.
D) simile.
E) synecdoche.

64. In all likelihood, the published beauty (lines 10-11) to which the speaker refers is

A) an epistolary novel.
B) a fashion magazine.
C) a lithographic printing.
D) a love letter.
E) the poem itself.

65. The theme of Ransom's "Blue Girls" can be succinctly represented by the formula

A) *carpe diem*.
B) *memento mori.*
C) *ubi sunt.*
D) *vade mecum.*
E) *verbum infans.*

Part 4: Tie-Breaking Essay (required)

Note well: Contestants who do not write an essay will be disqualified even if they are not involved in any tie.

Note well: Any essay that does not demonstrate a sincere effort to discuss the assigned topic will be disqualified. The judge(s) should note carefully this criterion when breaking ties: ranking of essays for tie-breaking purposes should be based primarily on how well the topic has been addressed.

Three sheets of paper have been provided for this essay; your written response should reflect the *Handbook*'s notion that an essay is a "moderately brief discussion of a restricted topic": something more than just a few sentences.

Read Robert Browning's "Memorabilia," and offer a discussion of the psychological aspect of memory as suggested by the poem-in-full.

Memorabilia

Ah, did you once see Shelley* plain,
And did he stop and speak to you?
And did you speak to him again?
How strange it seems, and new!

But you were living before that,
And you are living after,
And the memory I started a—
My starting moves your laughter!

I crossed a moor,* with a name of its own
And a certain use in the world no doubt,
Yet a hand's-breadth of it shines alone
Mid the blank miles round about:

For there I picked up on the heather*
And there I put inside my breast
A moulted feather, an eagle-feather—
Well, I forget the rest.

*** noted English Romanic poet**

*** broad area of open land**

*** flowering plant that grows on a moor**

KEY

UIL Literary Criticism
Invitational A • 2014

line arrows up ➔

1.	D	405
2.	A	45
3.	A	61
4.	E	486
5.	C	227
6.	A	4
7.	D	386
8.	B	603
9.	E	567
10.	C	
11.	B	294
12.	E	504
13.	D	208
14.	B	201
15.	B	267
16.	D	600
17.	E	426
18.	C	425
19.	A	608
20.	C	
21.	D	279
22.	B	174
23.	E	
24.	C	200
25.	E	449
26.	C	2
27.	B	606
28.	A	96
29.	D	345
30.	D	270
31.	B	309
32.	D	275
33.	B	254
34.	C	260
35.	C	249
36.	E	319
37.	B	210
38.	C	133
39.	A	68
40.	A	15/118
41.	E	127
42.	A	44
43.	A	178
44.	A	
45.	E	
46.	B	
47.	D	337
48.	C	196
49.	D	445
50.	A	13
51.	A	37
52.	E	486
53.	D	
54.	E	
55.	B	
56.	C	294
57.	C	257
58.	E	
59.	B	
60.	D	442
61.	B	298
62.	C	476
63.	D	445
64.	E	
65.	A	75

FOLD along the **three** longitudinal lines for ease in grading. ➔

Please note that the objective scores should not be altered to reflect the breaking of any ties. ***Simply adjust ranking***.

The thirty items in Part 1 are worth one point each.

The twenty items in Part 2 are worth two points each.

The fifteen items in Part 3 are worth two points each.

DO NOT mark (cross out) actual **LETTER** answer; mark the answer **NUMERAL**.

Page numbers refer to the *Handbook* 12e,

to the Signet *Tartuffe*,

to the Vintage *Pretty*,

and to Penguin's Browning collection.

Part 4: Tie-Breaking Essay

These notes are not intended to be understood as a key for the Tie-Breaking Essay prompt; rather, they should serve the judge(s) as a presentation of critical ideas that might appear in an essay responding to the prompt.

Criteria for judging the Tie-Breaking Essay **SHOULD** include

the degree to which the instructions have been followed,

the quality of the critical insight offered in response to the selection,

the overall effectiveness of the written discussion, and

the grammatical correctness of the essay.

Note well that the quality of the contestant's critical insight is more important than the contestant's prose style. In short, the Literary Criticism contest is one that promotes the critical analysis of literature. The quality of the writing, which should never go unappreciated, does not trump evidence of critical analysis.

Critical Notes on John

Literary concepts that **MIGHT** be used in a discussion of the psychology of memory in Browning's "Memorabilia" include

allusion,
apostrophe,
enjambment,
irony,
metaphor,
muse (inspiration),
speaker,
theme, and
tone.

Browning, as speaker, recalls meeting someone who recalls having once met Percy Bysshe Shelley. The contestant might recognize a progression, obvious in the shift from an excitement engendered by meeting someone who has himself met someone famous to an excitement reduced by the laughter that is invoked by memory: the person to whom the speaker is talking laughs at the speaker's being excited that he has met someone, someone who apparently questions Shelley's famousness. The last two stanzas place the importance of the speaker's meeting the person who has met Shelley up against the speaker's own memory of once having crossed a moor, an event that has apparently been reduced to the singularity of remembering his finding an eagle's feather—a molted feather, which feather serves, first, as an artifact recalling the eagle's most recent year of splendor (the feather now "forgotten") and, second, as a metaphor for memory.

The young writer might focus on the memory's inability to sustain itself in emotional terms, down to the point at which the poem's last line, perhaps ironically, reminds us that memory fails unless there is a physical object to remind: memorabilia.

The writer might recognize the distance travelled during recollection as metaphorically the same as the distance traveled across a moor that might have some "use in the world no doubt"—a moor/a life/a memory that every now then has had a moment that "shines alone" (line 11), that stands out like the eagle feather, which itself has had a life of its own but is now but a memory: not unlike the degree of separation that defines Browning's speaker having met someone who had met someone . . . .